

ARISE

Adolescent Reproductive Health Information Support & Empowerment

LIFE SKILLS

Life Skills — Decision Making

Student Study Guide & Quiz Answer Key

Module:	Life Skills
Lesson:	Life Skills — Decision Making
Quiz:	25 marks (10 MCQ + 5 Fill-in-blanks + 3 Short Answer)
Pass Mark:	15/25 (60%) — Certificate awarded at 60%+
Languages:	English Kiswahili Sheng

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to:

1. Define life skills and explain their importance for adolescents
2. Distinguish assertive, aggressive, and passive communication
3. Apply active listening and empathy in relationships
4. Use the 5-step problem-solving model and refusal skills

Slide 2: What Are Life Skills?

The WHO defines life skills as psychosocial abilities that help us handle everyday challenges effectively.

Life Skill	Why It Matters
Communication	Express needs, resolve conflicts
Decision-Making	Choose wisely under pressure
Problem-Solving	Find solutions, not just complain
Empathy	Understand others, build trust
Coping with Stress	Stay mentally healthy
Self-Awareness	Know your strengths and limits

Slide 3: Communication Styles

How you communicate shapes every relationship in your life.

Style	What It Looks Like	Outcome
Assertive	Clear, respectful: "I feel X when Y happens"	Mutual respect, problems solved
Aggressive	Dominates, threatens, blames	Fear, damaged relationships
Passive	Avoids conflict, says nothing	Built-up resentment, ignored needs
Manipulative	Uses guilt, tricks, or lies	Broken trust

■ ■ *Tip*

Slide 4: Active Listening & Empathy

Most people listen to reply, not to understand. Active listening changes relationships.

KEY TERM: Empathy

The ability to understand and share the feelings of another — not feeling sorry FOR someone but feeling WITH them.

Zawadi was stressed about exams and started crying. Instead of saying 'don't cry, it's just exams', Baraka sat with her, listened, and said 'I can see this feels really overwhelming.' Zawadi felt understood and they studied together that evening.

Slide 5: Problem-Solving & Peer Pressure

A structured approach to problems keeps emotions from taking over.

Step	Description
1. Identify	Define the problem clearly
2. Generate Options	Brainstorm possible solutions
3. Choose	Pick the best option
4. Act	Implement your choice
5. Reflect	Did it work? What would you do differently?

■ ■ ■ Peer Pressure Alert

■ Phrases like 'everyone is doing it', 'don't be a coward', or 'just this once' are classic pressure tactics. You do NOT have to follow the crowd.

Slide 6: Module Video

Watch carefully, then continue to the scenarios.

Slide 7: Real Talk — What Would You Do?

Pick your choice and see the consequence.

Slide 8: Refusal Skills & Trusted Adults

Saying NO is a life skill. Here is how to do it effectively.

Quiz — Answer Key

Total: 25 marks | Pass: 15/25 (60%) | Certificate at 60%+

Part A: Multiple Choice (10 marks)

1. 1. Life skills are best defined as:

- ☐ A. School subjects like maths and science
- ☒ **B. Abilities that help you handle challenges and make responsible decisions**
- ☐ C. Sports and physical activities
- ☐ D. Religious teachings only

2. 2. Effective communication involves:

- ☐ A. Talking as much as possible
- ☒ **B. Sending, receiving, and understanding messages clearly**
- ☐ C. Using complex vocabulary
- ☐ D. Only written messages

3. 3. Active listening means:

- ☐ A. Waiting for your turn to speak
- ☒ **B. Fully concentrating on the speaker, understanding, and responding thoughtfully**
- ☐ C. Nodding without listening
- ☐ D. Listening only to people you like

4. 4. Which communication style is most healthy?

- ☐ A. Aggressive — dominating the conversation
- ☐ B. Passive — never expressing your feelings
- ☒ **C. Assertive — expressing yourself clearly and respectfully**
- ☐ D. Manipulative — getting what you want through tricks

5. 5. Peer pressure is best handled by:

- ☐ A. Always doing what your friends do
- ☒ **B. Using assertive refusal skills and offering alternatives**
- ☐ C. Avoiding all social situations
- ☐ D. Pretending to agree then doing what you want

6. 6. A 'trusted adult' is important because:

- ☐ A. They always agree with you
- ☒ **B. They can provide guidance, support, and connect you to help**
- ☐ C. They know all the answers
- ☐ D. They keep all your secrets forever

7. 7. Problem-solving steps in the correct order are:

- ☐ A. Act → Identify → Evaluate
- ☒ **B. Identify → Generate options → Choose → Act → Reflect**
- ☐ C. Guess → Try → Forget
- ☐ D. Ask everyone → Copy their answer

8. 8. Non-verbal communication includes:

- ☐ A. Text messages

☒ **B. Body language, facial expressions, eye contact, and tone**

☐ C. Phone calls only

☐ D. Written letters

9. 9. Empathy in communication means:

☐ A. Feeling sorry for someone

☒ **B. Understanding and sharing the feelings of another person**

☐ C. Ignoring others' problems

☐ D. Giving advice immediately

10. 10. The best response when a friend shares a personal problem is:

☐ A. Change the topic quickly

☒ **B. Listen actively, acknowledge feelings, then offer support**

☐ C. Tell everyone else immediately

☐ D. Give a long lecture on what they should have done

Part C: Short Answer (25 marks)

1. 1. The ability to express your needs clearly and respectfully is called _____ communication. (3 marks)

2. 2. Listening fully and responding thoughtfully is called _____ listening. (3 marks)

3. 3. Body language, eye contact, and facial expressions are forms of _____ communication. (3 marks)

4. 4. Understanding and sharing the feelings of another person is called _____. (3 marks)

5. 5. The first step in problem-solving is to clearly _____ the problem. (3 marks)

6. Describe THREE differences between assertive, aggressive, and passive communication styles. (3 marks marks) (3 marks)

7. Explain the 5 steps of effective problem-solving and give an example from school life. (4 marks marks) (4 marks)

8. Why are life skills important for adolescents specifically? Give TWO reasons. (3 marks marks) (3 marks)